Having dealt with these dual natural calamities, he has proceeded to rectify what he calls the "man-made calamities" inflicted by the previous government that had drained the economy of funds for growth. Spelling out an economic vision for the state that he calls the 'Dravidian Model of Development', Stalin told INDIA TODAY, "Our target is to become a one trillion dollar economy by 2030. However, mere economic development is not our goal, it has to be looked through the prism of people's welfare. I have been continuously emphasising that our Dravidian model of development should be steered by the inclusivity criterion, embracing everyone, every sector, and every district." (*See interview.*)

In doing so, Stalin is only carrying forward the core philosophy of growth with equity that successive Tamil Nadu governments have followed, which perhaps explains the state's long reign at the top of INDIA TODAY's annual State of the States survey. Tamil Nadu has emerged as the best performing big state for the fifth consecutive year, with Stalin maintaining the pace of his predecessors. If he could take only partial credit for the state emerging on top last year, Stalin can claim the prize as his own this year as the state figures among the top five in nine out of 12 categories among the best performing big states. It is numero uno in inclusive development; in second place in economy; third in infrastructure, cleanliness and health; No. 4 in law & order, environment and education; and fifth in entrepreneurship.

BEST PERFORMING BIG STATES OVERALL

RANK 2022	STATE	SCORE OUT OF 2080	RANK 2021	RANK 2020	RANK 2019	RANK 2018
1	TAMIL NADU	1,321.5	1	1	1	1
2	HIMACHAL PRADESH	1,312.5	2	2	2	7
3	KERALA	1,263.5	3	4	5	3
4	GUJARAT	1,217.7	4	5	6	4
5	PUNJAB	1,215.1	5	3	4	5
6	MAHARASHTRA	1,209.2	9	8	9	8
7	UTTARAKHAND	1,173.2	11	12	11	11
8	ANDHRA PRADESH	1,172.9	6	7	8	10
9	KARNATAKA	1,161.1	10	11	7	6
10	HARYANA	1,149.3	8	6	3	2
11	TELANGANA	1,133.3	7	9	10	9
12	WEST BENGAL	1,070.8	12	10	12	13
13	MADHYA PRADESH	972.9	13	13	14	12
14	RAJASTHAN	930.6	14	14	13	15
15	ODISHA	909.8	16	16	17	18
16	CHHATTISGARH	899.7	15	15	16	17
17	ASSAM	887.5	17	19	18	19
18	UTTAR PRADESH	852.8	18	17	15	14
19	JHARKHAND	751.4	19	18	19	21
20	BIHAR	739.2	20	20	20	20

Excellence on all these counts has cemented Tamil Nadu's status as India's best performing state. In its 20th edition now, the INDIA TODAY State of the States survey and rankings have come to be regarded as the gold standard in objectively assessing the performance of states through curated parameters and attributes based on comprehensive data. Over the years, several refinements have been made and the analysis made more robust. To provide a level playing field, states are divided into big—those with an area of 35,000 square kilometres or more and a population of over 5 million—and small, which includes the rest. Twelve key categories were identified to compare the performance of states—economy, infrastructure, agriculture, health, education, governance, law & order, inclusive development, entrepreneurship, tourism, environment and cleanliness.

To reward those who have performed well in the past five years, INDIA TODAY introduced the most improved states category in 2011. So, while the results of the best performing states are based on the most recent data across 125 parameters, most improved states are judged on the basis of 89 parameters